

Barrier Breakers Judging Rubric

Gallery Round & Demo Day · One card, three questions



Every judge scores every team they see on the same three questions, **1 to 5 each**. In the morning gallery round, each section's panel of three uses these scores to pick its **finalist** and **runner-up**. In the afternoon, the Demo Day panel (the morning judges who can stay, at least five) uses the same card to rank the five finalists.

The Three Questions **15 POINTS PER JUDGE**

Criterion	Points
Problem — Do they understand it? Who this barrier hurts, why it exists, and what it actually costs people. A 5 means the team can point to specific numbers, people, or root causes, not just a headline.	5
Solution — Is it real? Would it work, could it actually be built or run, and does it lower the barrier for the people in the problem? Prototypes, drafts, and evidence of testing all count.	5
Pitch — Can they explain it? Clear in 60 seconds, solid under questions. Did the team answer what was asked, and did every member seem to own the project?	5
TOTAL (per judge)	15

Scoring Scale · use the whole range

1 Missing or unclear	2 Thin	3 Solid	4 Strong	5 Exceptional
--------------------------------	------------------	-------------------	--------------------	-------------------------

Gallery Round (Morning)

Component	Time
Pitch The team pitches from their table, with whatever they brought: a poster, a prototype, a demo on a laptop. A volunteer keeps time. Hard stop at 60 seconds.	60 sec
Judge Q&A Ask what the pitch didn't answer. Push on the problem, the solution, or both.	2 min

Score & move

30 sec

Each judge scores on their phone before walking to the next table.

How a section picks its finalist. The room is split into five sections. Each section has a panel of three judges who visit every table in that section and nobody else's.

- The panel's combined score (out of 45) ranks the section. Highest goes to Demo Day; second is the section's honorable mention.
- Panels compare only within their own section. Never against other sections' scores.
- At the end of the round, the three judges huddle for five minutes to confirm the top two and break any tie.

Demo Day (Afternoon)

Component	Time
Pitch Presentation The five finalists present to the Demo Day panel and the whole room. Slides optional but recommended.	5 min
Judge Q&A Questions from any judge on the panel.	2 min
Ranking Every Demo Day judge scores all five on the same three questions, fresh, including the finalist from their own morning section. Combined scores rank 1st through 5th; the panel huddles to break ties.	After final pitch

Questions? Contact competition@finmango.org

finmango.org/barrier-breakers